



SOC201 Classical Sociological Theory Complete Study Guide

Sociological Theory (University of Toronto)



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SOC201: Classical Sociological Theory

Lecture 1:

- Discussion about the COVID rise time
- George Floyd and protests
- Capitol attacks
- Russia Ukraine invasion
- Set of tools to make sense of the world and what's happening in it today.
- "Classical Theories for International Sociology"

Lecture 2:

- Speaking about the 2016 US election and Donald Trump winning.
- Alexis de Tocqueville would say don't worry; after all, he is just the president of the US.
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Thesis:

- Tocqueville believed that the SOCIAL STRUCTURE of AMERICAN SOCIETY helped to DETER and PREVENT successful rise to power of a DESPOT.
- Despot:
 - Someone who has absolute power and can use it in awful ways
 - A ruler who holds absolute power and who exercises it in a cruel and oppressive way.

Outline:

- Meet Alexis de touqueville
- Social Structure
- The Social Structure of the United States

Meet Alexis De Touqueville:

- Born in France in 1805
 - Napoleon
 - Crowned emperor of France due to conquests 1804, In 1805 crowned king of Italy. By 1810, most of Europe except Portugal and UK.
 - This is the concept he was born with, the Despot ruler's story.

- The story of how Louis was overthrown and executed
- Purge of revolution 'Reign of Terror'
- France in Chaos, directorate chose to make stability.
- Napoleon overthrows the directorate and throws a coupe.
- Tocqueville wanted to know how France would stage a revolution for democracy and, in ten years, find itself ruled by an absolute ruler again.
- Only one country was truly successful in democracy at that time, USA.

Democracy in America:

- Essentially an argument for why democracy is so successful in America.
- The SOCIAL STRUCTURE of AMERICAN SOCIETY helped to DETER and PREVENT the successful rise to the power of a DESPOT.
- The idea of social structure.

Social Structure:

- Patterned social arrangements in a society are both emergent from and determinant of the actions of individuals.
- Examples
 - Family
 - Religion
 - Law
 - Economy
 - Class
- French Social Structure
 - Absolute Monarchy
 - Feudal Nobility
 - Established Church
 - Centralized State Bureaucracy
 - Large Metropolitan Areas
 - Industrialized Centres
- Alexis de Tocqueville felt all these conditions allowed people like napoleon to take power.
- Less to do with ideologies but more with structures.
- What about the American Social Structure
 - Never had a Monarchy
 - No Feudal Nobility

- No Established Church (Those that came to the US were trying to escape the authority of the Church)
 - No Centralized State Bureaucracy (Power was not centralized)
 - No Large Metropolitan Areas (They didn't exist to the same extent as they did in France)
 - No Industrialized Centres (They didn't exist to the same extent as they did in France)
 - Limitation: Completely excludes Slavery and rights to vote
- American Political Structure:
 - Federal Government
 - States within the country that have their own government and legislature
 - Multiple Levels of government that share power
 - Bicameral legislature
 - If you look at your legislature, it's not just one group but two. For eg House of Commons and the Upper house.
 - Makes it harder for an authoritarian ruler to take control
 - Three Branches of government
 - The Legislative Power
 - Pass the laws
 - Executive power
 - Executes the laws
 - Judiciary
 - Supreme courts make sure the laws are followed

Central Arguments: Tocqueville

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Lecture 3:

1. Meet Karl Marx
2. What is the German Ideology
3. World history 101
4. Social structure and Materialism
5. Ruling Ideology

Marx:

- Graduated from uni of Berlin with Ph.D. at of 24
- Becomes editor of the newspaper
- Berlin govt banned the newspaper a few years later
- Marries had a family, Happily married.
- All had to leave Germany for france in Paris
- Met Engels in Paris, was rich and able to provide financial support for their efforts and became co-authors.
- Marx exiled again from Paris and moves to Brussels in Belgium: Forms the german workers part and becomes socially active
- Kicked out of Belgium again
- Finally moves to London and famously does research at the British Library.
- Died poor. Spent much of the rest of his life in industrial London 1900s

The German Ideology

- The theoretical ideas and writing of philosopher HEGEL and the critique of his writing by older and young scholars.
- What were the ideals of Hegel:
- Hegel was using Dialectical philosophy
- The Idea of negation, asking a question, getting an answer and constantly challenged and critiqued the answers
- We have to see the world for what it isnt yet
- Everything in our world is in constant transformations
- We have to see the world for its limitations to move forward
- Dialectical Philosophy
 - The Form in which a thing immediately appears is not its true form.
 - History Proceeds through negation and synthesis of ideas.

World History 101:

- Karl Marx agrees that history is a constant struggles but disagrees with Hegels view since it is all about ideas and philosophy, whereas marx says there is something real about it.
- The History of Civilisation
 - Hunter Gatherer Societies
 - Then happened the agricultural revolution
 - Trade, Art, Writing, Religion
 - Slave Societies
 - Following the revolution, institutional slavery.
 - Examples: Ancient egypt, rome, greece, mohenjo daro, indus valley civilisation.

- Feudalism
 - Replaced Slaved societies
 - After the Fall of Rome, A post apocalyptic society
 - Soon after followed the Black Death
 - Shortly after, Martin luther starts the protestant revolution
 - Changes in medicine and technology
- Capitalism
 - After all the revolutions, capitalism followed
- Due to dialectical thinking that Capitalism may not also remain forever, another big revolution could come. (Communism)

Materialism and Social Structure:

- Dialectical Historical Materialism
 - The history of a society is an ongoing struggle and conflict over the control of ways in which we produce necessities in order to survive.
- Bourgeoisie
 - The exclusive owners of the means of production
- Means of Production
 - Includes both the productive forces and the social relations required to produce the necessities for survival in a particular way
- Proletariat
 - The working class labourers who do not have control over the means of production and thus have to work for wages in order to survive
- Base
 - The productive forces and social forces and social relations required to produce the necessities in order to survive form the foundation of our society.
 - We can always relate sociology to base.
 - Sociology ultimately rooted to base
 - Reason for our laws comes down the base
 - Culture, education, philosophical ideas about what is right and wrong is also rooted in Base
 - Our social interactions, personal interactions
 - Base changed from hunter gatherers, slave society, feudal system, and capitalism.
- Superstructure
 - Everything else in Society.

“It is a truth universally acknowledged that a single man in possession of a good fortune, must be in want of a wife”

Ideology:

- Material Conditions tend to perpetuate rather than resist the existing means of production.

Branches of Government:

1. The Legislative Power
2. Executive Power
3. Judiciary

Ruling Ideology:

- Ruling Ideology used by the Bourgeoisie to Justify and Legitimate the Capitalist Base that allows them to maintain control over the means of production.

Week 4: Karl Marx: The economist: The British rule in India and the future of the British rule in India

The Economics of Karl Marx

Branches of Government

1. The Legislative Power
 - a. Has to take into consideration big corporate powers
2. Executive Power
3. Judiciary

Ideology

- Material Conditions tend to perpetuate rather than resist the existing means of production.
- Ruling Ideology
 - Ruling Ideology used by the Bourgeoisie to Justify and Legitimate the Capitalist Base that allows them to maintain control over the means of production.

Alienation

- Separation of workers from the means of production and subsistence.
- Separation of workers from what they produce.

- Separation of workers from other workers.
 - Separation of workers from their own creative potential.
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- Use Value: A function of the actual physical properties of a commodity. They determine how a commodity can be used.
 - Capital: The value of a good or service.
 - Exchange value: The worth of a commodity relative to other commodities.

The Labour Theory of Value

- Reproducing the worker: The exchange value of Labour has traditionally and historically become understood to be the amount of money necessary for a worker to subsist and therefore come back to work the next day.
- Surplus Value: The difference between the use value and exchange value of Labour Power.

Fair

Fair Market

Exploitation!!

The Army of the Unemployed

- Floating Reserves: Workers, usually in the urban centers of the industry, who were temporarily unemployed; for example, between jobs.
- Latent Reserves: A 'reservoir' of potential worker, such as people in the process of being pushed off farm lands.

Lecture 5: Karl Marx "The Communist"

"A spectre is haunting Europe.."

- Reflecting back on Karl Marx, the historian.
- A time when it wasn't unusual for sociologists to say we should study society and the world scientifically.
- Critiquing Capitalism in almost everything you read.

- The exploitation of the working class.
 - Exploitation happened at every stage of history. Relating to capitalism.
 - Conflict
 - It allows us to see what the critiques of Marx
 - Things we do not have full answers to.
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- At the beginning of The Communist Manifesto, Karl Marx and Friedrich Engels establish communism as an outsider philosophy and its Manifesto as a reactionary, revolutionary document
 - 19th-century European powers perceived communism simultaneously as an insubstantial force and an evil presence; though the influence of communism was widespread at this time in history, communism was not widely understood
 - Marx generally agreed with Hegel's theory of history. He accepted that shifts must take place from
 - 1) tribalism (a means of production owned and shared by individuals whose relationships with each other are based on kinship) to
 - 2) slave-owning (a means of production and land managed and owned by a master) to
 - 3) feudalism (a means of production characterized by aristocratic rule) to
 - 4) a bourgeois-run capitalist society (characterized by a powerful but oppressive middle class) to
 - 5) a revolution of the proletariat (the rise of the working man and true equality). Each step must be followed by the next, and each stage represents a general improvement in the human condition. [COMMUNAL OWNERSHIP/ COMMUNISM]
 - Societies cannot skip over a stage; each is necessary for the development of humanity as a whole.
 - For Marx, the single most important factor in determining historical progress is the society's economic system.
 - He was especially interested in identifying which class owned the means of production. For Marx, class struggle is the key to understanding history; therefore, economics must be spotlighted because classes rise from the economic structures of their societies.

CONFLICT:

- Conflict Theory or the Conflict perspective
- The modern sociological theory that we use today
- Tries to address limitations of Marx
- Critique 1
- Years following the death of Marx. There were several scholars that began to critique Marx of being a 'Reductionist', more specifically 'economic reductionist.'
 - Reduction: Reducing someone or something to a certain trait or perspective.
 - Marx has been reduced to Economics.
 - What he was trying to do was to boil everything down to the economy.

- Everything is caused by the economy, by capitalism.
 - Base - Super structure relationship
 - Critics said there is more to society than just capitalism.
 - Critique 2
 - He relied too much on causality
 - The idea that the economy causes everything else
 - Industrial capitalism was caused by society
 - Focused perhaps too much on how A causes B
 - Some argue that these might have been misinterpretations of his point of view.
 - E.g., He says only certain aspects of society are influenced by the economy.
 - Counter Argument 1: Maybe we are overemphasizing how much Marx associated society with the base.
 - Counter Argument 2: Economy and society can also be influenced by major significant military conquest.
 - What Marx says in society is conflict.
 - He saw the conflict as perhaps the ultimate driving force, and a consequence of that is the Rise of "Neo-Marxism" - A more modern, new version of Marxist theory.
 - Neo-Marxism: Use conflict theory and do not have to be about bourgeoisie and proletariat. You can be figurative while using those term to describe groups who has monopoly and power.
 - Conflict theory can be used to understand Male supremacy or patriarchy, gender violence in criminology, etc. How can society be structured based on gender conflict?
 - The same is about Race and Ethnicity. We do not necessarily treat them as economic classes but more of how society is structured based on racial conflict.
 - Similarly, regarding Sexual orientation, we don't need to reduce it to the economy.
 - Takeaway: The core of all of Marx's ideas is that our society is structured but the social structure is not necessarily tools, factories, or ways in which things are produced but instead other forms of conflict that are our conflicts with each other.
 - Conflict over power.
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- What about Conflict theory in terms of comparative sociology?
 - We can compare different types of conflict around the world, and identify classes, interests, values, etc.
 - We have to explore the other side of Marx as well.
 - He was a political activist
 - Fighting for communism
 - The Communist Revolution
 - Central Argument in the reading
 - A revolution will come from the proletariat, who are the vast majority.

- Bourgeois society is very unstable.
- It will occur when capitalism has reached its height.
- Inequality at its extreme leading to a kickstart motion towards communism.
- How will be reconnected to our work
 - The abolition of our property
- The revolution is inevitable
- What the world might look like
 - We might not be alienated anymore
 - We do what we need to survive
 - We do what we are happy with doing
 - A world where you could largely pick what you want to do in a day
 - You're relatively happy
 - No one is necessarily rich
 - But Nobody is suffering
- Marx didn't really structure what a communist government would look like.
 - There might not be any political parties
 - Democracy is duped into capitalism.
 - A world without law, crime, want government, or utopia.

Lecture 6: Max Weber - The Ghost Whisperer

- Verstehen: The science of developing an empathetic understanding of meanings associated with socially oriented behaviors.
- 'The Principle of joint liability and a separate fund of general partnership out of the household communities and commercial associations in Italian cities.
- Weber was consumed in debate with the ghost of Marx.
- Apparently trying to argue and debate with Karl Marx in his works.
- Was essentially trying to debate whether the economic system causes everything in our society. Opposed to this monocausal explanation of society.
- Some key Takeaways from Marx:
 - We began to question Marx's methods
 - Base and Super structure.
 - Exploitation in the means of production: Bourgeoisie and proletariat.
 - Ways in which Karl Marx have been use ever since (Neo Marxism).

Weberian Stratification:

A multidimensional approach to social stratification that reflects and the interplay between wealth, but also both prestige and power.

- Class: The position of individuals in the market. This position within the market directly affects one's life chances.
- Class Power: There is unequal access to material resources and Weber saw this as the key, core component of stratification in society.
 - A more complex picture of class.
 - We don't want to conclude that Weber was not ultimately concerned about money and labour.
- Status: Prestigious position held within the stratification system based on "social honour" as opposed to one's economic position.
- Party: Associations that aim to secure power within an organization for its leaders to achieve material advantages for its active members.
- Traditional Authority: Legitimacy based upon the Belief in the sanctity of tradition.
- Charisma: Personal Characteristics that sets a person believed to possess it apart from ordinary people. The charismatic individual is usually regarded as possessing exceptional, even superhuman powers.
- Charismatic Authority: Power legitimized on the basis of a leader's exceptional personal qualities or the demonstration of extraordinary insight and accomplishment, which inspire loyalty and obedience from followers.

Rational Legal Authority:

- This is a form of leadership in which the authority of an organization or a ruling regime is tied to legal rationality, legal legitimacy, and bureaucracy.
- Legitimacy comes from a legal order and laws that are lawfully enacted and legally enforced.
- (thus: not the content of the law that matters as much as how the law was created and enforced).

Lecture 7: Max Weber 2: The Protestant Ethic and the Spirit of Capitalism

- Power: The Probability that one actor in a social relationship can carry out their own will, despite resistance.
- Traditional Authority: When the legitimacy of authority is based on belief in traditions that specify who an appropriate authority should be.
- SIDE NOTE: Main idea of the protestant ethic:

- Weber was interested in how and where capitalism began.
- Said that we must look at what's going on regarding religious belief.
- The doctrine of predestination: Our fate is already sealed
- Where you end up going after you die has already been determined (Calvinism)
- For virtually all of us, heaven is not the next place that our soul goes.
- It Doesn't matter if you repent or confess since there is no such thing as forgiveness.
- The sign that someone is going to heaven is a sign that they are successful in this life. (They have money, they work, financial success etc etc)
- That will motivate a lot of people to work hard.

Lecture 8 Max Weber (3) Methodology:

- The Role of Science: Science cannot tell us what we ought to do, but rather, what is likely to happen if we do it.
- Value Free sociology: Freeing oneself of all values in studying sociology or social phenomena.
- Objectivity: Considering all points of view, especially those that counter your own position.
- Value-relevant sociology: Becoming aware of our own values and their relevance to what we study.
- Methodenstreit: 19th and 20th-century scholarly debate over whether or not history and social science should be integrated or separate.
- Typologies: Utopias that are constructed by accentuating certain aspects of reality for heuristic purposes.
- Historical-Sociological Method: An adequate understanding of social facts requires understanding how they came to be.
- Counterfactual Thought Experiment: Imagining how to present might have unfolded differently if we remove one key actor from history.
- Social Action: People's Behaviour that takes into account the behaviors of other people.
- Verstehen: The science of developing an empathetic understanding of the meanings associated with socially oriented behaviors.

Social Constructionism

- Deviance: Behaviours that individuals or groups in society take offence to and react negatively to.
- Attributes that individuals or groups in society take offence to and react negatively to.
- Social Control:

- Informal Negative Reactions- Avoidance, epithets, ridicule, gossip, criticism. This can be both external and internal.
- Formal negative reactions- Official warnings, legal punishments, treatments.

Notes on Durkheim:

- <https://slideplayer.com/slide/7388468/>
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ICRECGVsaRo&ab_channel=SociologicalDictionary

Functionalism (<https://simplysociology.com/emile-durkheims-theories.html>)

Functionalism is a structural-consensus theory. This means that functionalists argue both that there is a social structure that shapes individual behavior through the process of socialization and that a successful society is based on value consensus, or people agreeing around a shared set of norms and values that enables people to co-operate and work together to achieve shared goals (Pope, 1975).

Functionalism is a framework in sociology that sees society as similar to a biological organism, with interrelated parts that have needs and functions, and structures that ensure that these parts work together to create a well-functioning society.

Durkheim is often considered to be a functionalist; however, he still understood that it was necessary to explain the reasons why particular social structures emerged historically.

There are two key ideas in Durkheim's works that are functionalist.

Firstly, Durkheim argued that society has a reality that is above the individuals who comprise it. Society shapes individuals, who are constrained by social facts, or ways of acting, thinking and feeling which are external to the individual and endowed with the power of coercion, controlling the individual.

Social facts can include beliefs, moral codes, and basic norms and values passed from one generation to the next and shared by individuals making up a society. In this case, it is not the consciousness of an individual that directs human behavior, but common beliefs and sentiments that shape their consciousness (Pope, 1975).

Secondly, Durkheim believed that too much freedom is bad for individuals. Too much freedom — or a lack of clear guidance about what is right or wrong can create a sense of confusion and uncertainty about an individual's place in the world, or what Durkheim calls "anomie."

In response, Durkheim argues that societies have a need to create social solidarity in order to give the people within them a sense of purpose and to teach them how to behave appropriately.

The structures that create social solidarity in society can include family, religion, schools, workplaces, and voluntary organizations (Pope, 1975).

Final Durkheim Lecture 2 Notes:

- Think of society as an organism
- An organism lives and survives because all of the things in an organism serve a function. (functionalist perspective)
- Schools, religion, law enforcement, etc serve a function
- Anomie: Breaks in organic solidarity when certain social functions are not well adjusted to one another. (a malfunctioning in society)
- Durkheim said that all sociology is comparative.
- If all social life is comparative then therefore we need crime as comparison to acceptable behaviour. If we lose crime we won't have anything to compare to.
- If in a world where there was no cold we would never be appreciate hot. Since we do not have anything to compare to.

Analysis of Religion:

(<https://revisesociology.com/2018/06/18/functionalist-perspective-religion-durkheim/>)

(<https://iep.utm.edu/emile-durkheim/#:~:text=According%20to%20Durkheim%2C%20religion%20is,his%20most%20important%20work%2C%20Forms.>)

- Beliefs: Collective representations that are common to everyone in society.
- Church: Group of people who share beliefs, practice rituals together and feel united to one another.
- According to Durkheim, religion is the product of human activity, not divine intervention. He thus treats religion as a sui generis social fact and analyzes it sociologically. Durkheim elaborates his theory of religion at length in his most important work, Forms.
- In order for humans to understand what the supernatural was they needed something to contrast.
- Humans understood the supernatural by first understanding what is not supernatural, what is ordinary and what can be observed.
- Arguing that spirituality and other religious duties may be socially constructed.
- Sacred: Words or expressions that only consecrated people were permitted to utter.
- Profane: The ordinary and the mundane

Georg Simmel Notes on superordination and subordination:

(http://maxweber.hunter.cuny.edu/pub/eres/SOC101_PIMENTEL/simmel.html)

(<https://www.kobo.com/ca/en/ebook/superiority-and-subordination-as-subject-matter-of-sociology>)

(https://www.international.gc.ca/world-monde/issues_development-enjeux_developpement/responses_conflict-reponse_conflits/crisis-crisis/ukraine-fact-fait.aspx?lang=eng)

(<https://www.theguardian.com/world/2022/feb/25/pure-orwell-how-russian-state-media-spins-ukraine-invasion-as-liberation>)

- "Superiority and Subordination as Subject-Matter of Sociology" is an essay by the German Sociologist, philosopher and critic, Georg Simmel. In it, he shows that domination does not lie in the unilateral imposition of the superordinate's will upon the subordinate but that it involves reciprocal action. What appears to be the exercise of absolute power by some and the acquiescence by others is deceptive. Power "conceals an interaction, an exchange . . . which transforms the pure one-sidedness of superordination and subordination into a sociological form." Thus, the superordinate's action cannot be understood without reference to the subordinate, and vice versa. The action of one can only be analyzed by reference to the action of others, since the two are part of a system of interaction that constrains both.
- Every social occurrence as such, consists of an interaction between individuals. In other words, each individual is at the same time an active and a passive agent in a transaction. In case of superiority and inferiority, however, the relation assumes the appearance of a one-sided operation; the one party appears to exert, while the other seems merely to receive an influence. Such, however, is not in fact the case. No one would give himself the trouble to gain or to maintain superiority, if it afforded him no advantage or enjoyment. This return to the superior can be derived from the relation, however, only by virtue of the fact that there is a reciprocal action of the inferior upon the superior. The decisive characteristic of the relation at this point is this, that the effect which the inferior actually exerts upon the superior is determined by the latter. The superior causes the inferior to produce a given effect which the superior shall experience. In this operation, in case the subordination is really absolute, no sort of spontaneity is present on the part of the subordinate. The reciprocal influence is rather the same as that between a man and a lifeless external object with which the former performs an act for his own use. That is, the person acts upon the object in order that the latter may react upon himself. In this reaction of the object no spontaneity on the part of the object is to be observed, but merely the further operation of the spontaneity of the person. Such an extreme case of superiority and inferiority will scarcely occur among human beings. Rather will a certain measure of independence, a certain direction of the relation proceed also from the self-will and the character of the subordinate. The different cases of superiority

and inferiority will accordingly be characterized by differences in the relative amount of spontaneity which the subordinates and the superiors bring to bear upon the total relation. In exemplification of this reciprocal action of the inferior, through which superiority and inferiority manifests itself as proper socialization, I will mention only a few cases, in which the reciprocity is difficult to discern...

Superordination

Superordination may be exerted by 1) an individual, 2) a group, or 3) an objective force (social or ideal).

Subordination of a group under an individual can lead to decisive unification of the group in one of two ways:

- 1) A pre-existing organic group consists of an internal unit with its head. Here the ruler leads the group forces and will of the group finds unitary expression or body.
- 2) A group unites in opposition to its head and forms a party against the head. Here superordination by the ruler is the actual cause of sociation among group members.

Simmel also brings up the point that not just equal, but also unequal, relations of group members to the dominating head can give solidity to the social form characteristic of subordination under the individual. Here the varying distance or closeness to the leader creates a differentiation. In such a case, the formal characteristics of subordination under the individual may obtain even where the superordinate is a "collective individual" so-to-speak (Simmel uses the example of "the Brahman" in the Hindu caste system). Common enmity is a particularly potent catalyst to groups solidarity in cases where the common adversary is also the common ruler. Simmel suggests that there is at least a latent character of enmity in most relations to the ruler which exist as a combination of obedience and opposition. Contrary to the foregoing, in some cases common subordination of a group to a ruling power can lead to dissociation.

Simmel cites a "threshold phenomenon": when enmity between social elements exceeds a certain limit common oppression has a dissociative effect. There are two reasons: 1) once there is a domination resentment in a certain direction additional strain only served to intensify the general irritation, and 2) common suffering by pressing suffering elements closer together reveals more strikingly their inner distance and irreconcilability.

The Higher Tribunal is another unifying element of subordination; a party (abstract or consisting of a person or group of individuals) that exists on a higher plane to which all members of a group occupy an equally subordinate position and to which one appeals for decisions or whose interference one accepts because it is felt to be legitimate. Removing discord between parties is often easier if they both stand under such a higher power. Such a higher tribunal may be pre-existing, or a transformation of elements could bring about a new situation where parties are placed upon a new and common basis.

Subordination under a Plurality

The significance (or effect) of superordination by a plurality for the subordinates varies greatly from case to case.

One of the most important factors distinguishing this form of subordination (from that under an individual) lies in that character of objectivity obtaining to the relationship. This characteristic excludes certain feelings, impulses, and leanings that are effective in individual (but not in collective) actions. The source of variation in the subjective condition of these relationship lies in the particular expression of this "objective" characteristic in actual instances. For example in certain cases subordination under a plurality may give the relationship an air of distance or impartiality that can benefit the subordinate. On the other hand this objectivity often displays a negative character in case of collective behavior - namely, the suspension of certain norms to which the single individual ordinarily adheres. The brutality and mercilessness observed in crowd action or riots, Simmel believes, results because a collective has no subjective state of mind and is unable to mentally recreate suffering - an essential source of compassion - in the same way as an individual can.

Simmel distinguishes between two kinds of collectivities:

- 1) an abstract plurality such as a church, state, or similar entity that could be described as a 'legal person.' Such a group is the result of a plurality as a self-consistent and particular structure - the embodiment of an abstraction.
- 2) a physically co-present mass which is simple a group of people gathered in physical and temporal proximity/contact. It is to this latter kind of plurality that Simmel primarily attributes the negative attributes of the suspension of personal differences, which occurs in both types of collectivities. A classic example of this second type is the 'crowd' so-called - in fact Simmel seems to jump on the 'crowd mentality' bandwagon that was making the rounds at the turn of the century (maybe he shared a seat with Gustave LeBon:)

Subordination under a Principle

Subordination to an impersonal objective principle precludes a real, immediate interaction to the effect that the individual is deprived of some degree of freedom - ie we are subordinated in a relationship to an idea or ideal construction that we did not initiate and which we have little/no ability to alter. However, for modern objective individuals - according to Georg - subordination to a law which functions as the representative of impersonal, unfluencable powers is a more dignified condition than to be engaged in a more personal relation of subordination.

Changing gears a little, Simmel finds that Plato recognizes that the best means of counteracting selfishness among rulers is government by impersonal law. On the other hand Plato also believed that in the ideal state, the welfare of the whole required that the ruler stay above the law. Rigidity was felt to be a serious weakness of law, since rigid laws were poorly able to adapt to changing conditions. Plato felt that there should be laws that must never be broken only in the case where there were no true statesmen. Subordination under objects was one form of sub. under a principle that Simmel found particularly harsh and unconditional, since as much as a

person is subordinated by virtue of belonging to a thing, s/he psychologically sinks to the category of mere thing. Some examples would be Russian serfdom, patriarchal relations (belonging to a person), and to some extent in the case of the modern factory worker. Conscience: the superordinate principle can be interpreted as a psychological crystallization of an actual social power - the case of the moral imperative. The content of morality comes from social norms which are internalized into the individual through the process of socialization. So the moral command has the dual character of being at the same time personal and impersonal. At a higher state of morality, however, the contrast between individual and totality disappears and the norm acts as an end in itself which must be satisfied for its own sake - an abstract ideal. In practice, however, motivation for adhering to norms is mixed: a combination of individual, social, and abstract objectives.

- The coronation of King Charles and Marxism (The German Ideology)
(<https://www.marxist.com/the-british-monarchy-the-carnival-is-over.htm>)
- (<https://www.socialist.net/the-marxist-view-of-the-monarchy.htm>)
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What is meant by thoroughly introducing the current event?

Best way to format the final paper:

- Two broad ways to do it:
 - According to the list of thinkers and examples: for e.g. sections for each thinker.
 - Another option is that you can organize is based on your themes:
 - Three themes, for example:
 - Contributions:
 - Political contributions
 - Economic contributions
 - Sociocultural contributions
 - Other themes: Maybe historical\
 - Three dimensions of comparative sociology
 - In your thesis, if you are arguing about how these theorists pushed forward these themes. Then dividing thinkers according to themes.
- How long should it be:
 - 8-9 pages for a decent amount. Even 7 pages are fine if you can cover the content. Be sure to distribute your paper evenly among all the thinkers.
- Phrases like “in the reading about suicide” or “in the lecture about Marx’s economic theories” should be fine. Prof would know what we are talking about.
- You have to do more than summarise, you have to ASSESS as well. Think about the ways in which your summary can be analytical. Can you incorporate an argument? Talk critically and compare with all the other theorists in the list.

- Talk about lessons you got for comparative sociology:
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